Vocabulary Exam: GRE 333 (Word 1-160)

Total Marks: 35
Vocabulary: 15 marks
Writing: 20 marks

Time: 40 Minutes
Vocabulary: 20 Minutes
Writing: 20 Minutes

Instruction: Choose the option that best completes the sentence or correctly uses the given word according to the context.

01. The museum's new exhibition contains paintings, sculptures, photographs, and artifacts from cultures spanning several centuries. Rather than following one artistic tradition, the curator deliberately selected works from many different periods and styles to create a/an _____ collection.

A. austere
B. eclectic
C. derivative
D. banal
E. anomalous

02. Which of the following sentences uses *admonish* CORRECTLY?

A. The judge admonished the lawyer for repeatedly ignoring the court's instructions.
B. The architect admonished the building by adding two additional floors to it.
C. The scientist admonished the data by removing several inaccurate measurements.
D. The athlete admonished the race by finishing several minutes ahead of the other competitors.
E. The manager admonished the company's profits by investing the money in new equipment.

03. The village had depended on a single river for drinking water and agriculture for generations. When the river gradually became polluted, residents faced serious health and economic problems. The government subsequently introduced strict regulations to _____ the contamination and restore the quality of the water.

A. engender
B. exacerbate
C. disseminate
D. abate
E. emulate

04. Which of the following sentences uses *garrulous* INCORRECTLY?

A. The garrulous passenger talked continuously throughout the entire journey.
B. Because he was naturally garrulous, the professor often spent more time answering questions than delivering his lecture.

C. The normally garrulous politician remained silent throughout the press conference.

D. Her garrulous nature made her particularly popular at social gatherings.

E. The garrulous novel contained very few words and communicated its entire story through a series of photographs.

05. After weeks of negotiation, the two countries finally reached a temporary agreement. Although several major disagreements remained unresolved, the agreement was enough to _____ the immediate tension between the governments and prevent further escalation.

A. foment

B. exacerbate

C. assuage

D. bolster

E. forestall

06. Which of the following sentences uses *abstemious* CORRECTLY?

A. The professor was abstemious when explaining the complicated theory, using unnecessary technical terms.

B. Because of his abstemious personality, the politician frequently interrupted others and dominated every conversation.

C. The abstemious storm destroyed several buildings before moving out to sea.

D. Despite having access to an enormous variety of food, she remained abstemious, eating and drinking only in moderation.

E. The scientist's abstemious research produced dozens of contradictory conclusions.

07. The city had experienced months of political instability. Different groups competed for control, government institutions stopped functioning effectively, and there was no clear authority capable of maintaining order. In the absence of effective government, the country appeared to be descending into _____.

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A. approbation

B. decorum

C. anarchy

D. deference

E. equanimity

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08. Which of the following sentences uses *attenuate* INCORRECTLY?

A. Thick curtains were installed to attenuate the amount of sunlight entering the room.

B. The scientist used a filter to attenuate the intensity of the laser beam.

C. The medication was designed to attenuate the patient's severe symptoms.

D. The committee hoped that dialogue would attenuate the hostility between the two groups.

E. The new evidence attenuated the scientist's confidence by making the theory considerably more convincing.

09. The professor noticed that the student's essay contained several impressive arguments, but the overall structure was difficult to follow. Ideas that should have been connected appeared in separate paragraphs, and the conclusion introduced an entirely new topic. The essay was therefore criticized as being _____.

A. disjointed
B. cogent
C. assiduous
D. felicitous
E. homogeneous

10. Which of the following sentences uses *ambivalent* CORRECTLY?

A. The ambassador gave an ambivalent speech in which she clearly supported the proposal and rejected every alternative.

B. The machine became ambivalent after its electrical system was repaired.

C. The student felt ambivalent about studying abroad: she was excited by the opportunities but anxious about leaving her family.

D. The scientist described the chemical as ambivalent because it had a very high boiling point.

E. The painting was ambivalent because its colors were unusually bright and vivid.

11. When the company first launched its environmentally friendly packaging, sales were modest. After a popular environmental campaign highlighted the problem of plastic waste, however, consumer interest increased dramatically. The campaign acted as a _____, encouraging many more people to purchase the company's products.

A. deterrent
B. digression
C. catalyst
D. default
E. abeyance

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12. Which of the following sentences uses *guileless* INCORRECTLY?

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A. The child's guileless expression made it difficult for anyone to believe that he had deliberately deceived them.

B. Her guileless manner made her seem unusually sincere and straightforward.

C. The salesman was admired for his guileless approach because he never tried to manipulate customers.

D. The detective considered the witness guileless because her account appeared completely honest.

E. The politician's guileless strategy involved secretly deceiving voters while publicly pretending to support them.

13. The witness initially refused to answer the investigator's questions because she was afraid of becoming involved in the case. After being assured that she would receive legal protection, however, she agreed to provide information and _____ the investigators of everything she knew.

A. discredit
B. apprised
C. condoned
D. embellished
E. derided

14. Which of the following sentences uses *burgeon* CORRECTLY?

A. The researcher tried to disabuse the laboratory equipment so that it would produce more accurate measurements.

B. The company's profits began to burgeon after demand for its new product increased sharply.

C. The editor decided to desiccate the article by adding several pages of new examples and explanations.

D. The judge condoned the defendant by proving that he had been somewhere else when the crime occurred.

E. The historian distilled the ancient monument by constructing an exact replica of it.

15. The committee's initial proposal was met with strong opposition from several members. Rather than _____ the disagreement by defending the proposal aggressively, the chairperson adopted a _____ tone and invited everyone to suggest alternative solutions. After several hours of discussion, the members were able to _____ their differences and reach a compromise.

A. exacerbate — conciliatory — assuage
B. alleviate — contentious — foment
C. forestall — bombastic — denigrate
D. condone — austere — bolster
E. disseminate — dogmatic — exacerbate

Writing Questions:

01. Learning English vocabulary can be particularly challenging for non-native English speakers. Describe how you learned and improved your English vocabulary while preparing for your IBA MBA admission test. What methods or strategies did you find effective, and what would you recommend to others?

02. Battery-powered rickshaws have become a controversial issue in Dhaka because of concerns about traffic congestion, road safety, and the livelihoods of thousands of drivers. In your opinion, should battery-powered rickshaws be allowed to operate on the roads of Dhaka?

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